

TIM MORA

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Frontend engineer with a learning sciences background. Open to relocating — NYC / Chicago / Seattle / California

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — B.S. Computer Science + Education (Learning Sciences)

August 2026

GPA: 3.6 / 4.0 · Dean's List, Spring 2024

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Developer — Self-employed

April 2026 – Present

Champaign, IL

- Designed and built jennyfigment.com, a 16-page site for a children's book author — hand-written HTML, CSS, and JavaScript with no framework and zero dependencies.
- Built a CSS design system (~60 custom properties, fluid type scale, per-audience theming), five interactive activities including an **HTML5 Canvas** drawing app with a 15-state undo stack and PNG export, and bilingual English/Spanish support as an **ARIA tab pattern** with roving tabindex.
- Restructured the information architecture around three distinct audiences — young readers, parents, and educators booking school visits — replacing a single flat seven-item menu.
- Owned production: Apache rewrites for clean URLs, cPanel deployment, form integration, a Node build step for shared layout, and cross-device debugging. Delivered over 5 months and 51 commits.

Text Conversion Specialist — Disability Resources & Educational Services (DRES), UIUC

August 2025 – Present

Champaign, IL

- Produce accessible versions of academic course materials — LaTeX, Braille-ready, and tagged PDF — serving 100+ students per semester.
- Apply **WCAG** standards to bring digital course documents into institutional and federal accessibility compliance.

PROJECTS

Ordo — React, TypeScript, FastAPI, Supabase, Clerk, Claude API

2025 – 2026 · Live

- Solo-built a full-stack AI planner for students that reads syllabi, decomposes assignments with Claude, and schedules the pieces around real class blocks and daily capacity.
- Secured the backend with row-level security on every table, JWT validation, and per-user rate limiting; journal entries encrypted at rest with key rotation.
- Cut model cost with a fingerprint cache, relevance-filtered context, and Haiku-with-Sonnet-fallback routing.

HoloOrbits — Unity WebGL, Figma, UxD Learning Design

2025

- UX lead on a multiplayer orbital-mechanics simulation for secondary students, led by Dr. Jina Kang at UIUC; ran playthroughs and pilot tests to redesign the minimap, objectives tab, and multiplayer sync mechanic.
- Grounded design decisions in the Understanding by Design framework so simulation mechanics mapped to measurable learning outcomes.

Brandle — React, TypeScript, Supabase

2025 · Live

- Built a daily brand-guessing game over a hand-curated dataset of 200+ companies, with deterministic daily seeding, configurable difficulty, and color-coded proximity feedback across five attributes.
- Spent more time on data normalization than game logic — resolving subsidiary ambiguity, lagged revenue figures, and founding-year inconsistencies to make fairness a first-class design concern.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, HTML/CSS, C++, Java, Haskell

Frontend: React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, vanilla JS, Canvas API, Figma

Backend & Data: FastAPI, Node.js, Express, Supabase, PostgreSQL, REST APIs

Practices & Tools: Accessibility (WCAG, ARIA), Git, Docker, GitHub Actions, Vercel, Render, Claude API

LEADERSHIP

- **CS427 Software Engineering** — Project manager for an 8-person Android development team, running three parallel feature workstreams across an 8-week iteration cycle.